

University of Houston
English 4378 – Women Writers: Three Poets (26507)
WGSS 3322 – Intersectionalities: Three Poets (26888)
Spring 2017—T/Th 11:30am-1pm

Professor Gregory
624 Agnes Arnold

Office Hours: T/Th 1-2pm & by appt.
713-743-0932 egregory@uh.edu

Required Texts: Bishop, *Complete Poems* (FSG)
Brooks, *The Essential Gwendolyn Brooks* (Library of America)
Moore, *Observations* (Farrar, Straus, Giroux)
Moore, *Complete Poems* (Penguin Random House)
Leavell, *Holding On Upside Down* (FSG) - **begin now & finish by end of Spring Break (Rec)**
Additional readings, as assigned.

January 17 Introduction – Intersectionalities, Poetry & Authority
19 Patriarchy + Women Writers

<https://enc11457411.wordpress.com/2010/01/28/what-exactly-is-imperialist-white-supremacist-capitalist-patriarchy/>

Woolf ROOO chapters 1 - Roses Only, Labors of Hercules, England

<https://ebooks.adelaide.edu.au/w/woolf/virginia/w91r/>

24 Woolf ROOO chapters 2 -5 + Moore

26 Moore

Woolf response paper

The Past Is the Present, Pedantic Literalist, "He Wrote the History Book,"
Critics and Connoisseurs, To Be Liked by You Would Be a Calamity,
Sojourn in the Whale, My Apish Cousins, Reinforcements, Black Earth,
Radical, In the Days of Prismatic Color, Peter, Dock Rats, Picking and
Choosing, When I Buy Pictures, A Grave

31 Moore Those Various Scalpels, New York, Novices, Marriage,
An Octopus + MINA LOY Parturition (Blackboard)

February 2 Moore The Steeple Jack, The Student, The Hero, The Jerboa,
No Swan So Fine, The Plumet Basilisk, The Frigate Pelican, The Buffalo
TS Eliot: Introduction to Selected Poems (Blackboard)

7 Moore Half-Deity (handout), Virginia Britannia, Bird-Witted,
The Pangolin, What Are Years, The Paper Nautilus, In Distrust of Merits
Rachel Blau DuPlessis: "No Moore of the Same" (Blackboard)

9 Brooks Essential GB, xiii-27

Moore response paper

14 Brooks Essential GB, 28-58

16 Brooks Essential GB, 59-82

21 Brooks Essential GB, 83-87

23 Bishop CP pp. 3-21

Brooks response paper

28 Bishop CP pp. 22-52

March 2 Bishop CP pp. 55-68

7 Bishop CP pp. 69-84

9 Bishop Brooks Moore

Bishop response paper

14-16 SPRING BREAK – NO CLASS

21 Later Moore CP 141-174

23 Later Moore CP 177-202

28 Later Moore CP 205-247

FIRST PAPER DUE

30 Later Brooks In the Mecca (pdf posted)

April	4	Later Brooks	Essential GB, 88-113	
	6	Later Brooks	Essential GB, 114-133	
	11	Later Bishop	Questions of Travel, CP pp. 89-118	
	13	Later Bishop	Questions of Travel, CP pp. 121-134 + 146-154	
	18	Later Bishop	Questions of Travel, CP pp. 159-192	
	20	Presentations		
	25	Presentations		
	27	Presentations	LAST DAY OF CLASS	<u>closing discussion</u>
May	4	FINAL PAPER DUE		
	9	FINAL EXAM	11am to 2pm	

Course Requirements:

Four 2-3 page essays, one on each author – topic options listed on Blackboard **(7.5% each)**

Two 7-8 page essays each analyzing a text or texts by one or two of our authors, dealing with poetry and identity,– topic options on Blackboard – may include secondary sources **(15% each)**

In-class discussion (preparation, attendance and participation) will be graded and count for **10%** of grade. Includes one day/student posing introductory questions and some answers to the day's discussion (turn in typed sheet on your day). + mid-term teacher meeting

In-class presentation on another woman poet from the set posted on Blackboard **(10%)**

Final Exam (20%)

Attendance is mandatory; you are allowed **5** unexcused absences. An excused absence involves a formal document from an official or institution. Each unexcused absence after that will lower your grade by 3 pts. You may be dropped for excessive absences.

Learning Outcomes:

- Students will attain—through lectures, discussion & reading—and demonstrate—through exams & papers— knowledge about American poetry by women and dynamics of intersectional identity and authority.
- Class discussions of primary literary texts and secondary materials will help students develop critical reading & analytical thinking skills.
- Paper assignments will enable students to improve their writing skills & their analytic abilities.

Turning in papers

To prevent even the thought of plagiarism (quoting other people words or ideas in your papers without acknowledging the source), papers will be submitted via **Turnitin.com**—a program that vets papers for inappropriate borrowing. Submit through Blackboard turnitin.com function.

Computer and Phone Use

No computer use during class—if you bring one to class, please keep it closed. If you have a special circumstance that requires that you take notes on your computer, please talk to me after class. Cell phones & other communication devices should be turned off except in emergencies.

WGSS Credit

Both sections of this class can count for WGSS credit for minor or major. Talk with the adviser about which requirements it fulfills.